and anyone visiting the devastated areas was closely monitored. Ultimately, any direct aid from internal sources was forbidden. Local organizations were informed not to cooperate with monks trying to deliver any assistance. The government ended any aid delivery very quickly, claiming that assistance would create a level of dependency on the part of the citizens impacted by the disaster.

Harassment of relief workers was also commonplace and the comedian Zargana was arrested in Yangon in early June. Several dozen activists would be arrested by the end of the month for attempting to deliver aid to affected regions. The regime even utilized civilian thugs to brutalize volunteers attempting to establish an aid convoy.

The Myanmar government was also involved in serious misappropriation of aid. Assistance was diverted for resale or other illicit purposes. There were numerous episodes of authorities confiscating donated items that were sent to the Naypyidaw or sold at market places. In some cases, victims were charged for the assistance they received. Another ploy used by the regime was requiring a “yes” vote on the national referendum in order for aid to be handed out. Theft was commonplace at all levels of the military. Essential items for survival were confiscated, including mosquito netting, filters for water, tents, soap, stoves, and blankets. An additional problem was the distorted money exchange rates that benefitted the military regime. Over 10 million in aid may have been lost because of manipulation of money exchange rates.

The camp system established by the government was dismal. Food was inadequate and travel was restricted, leading to bribes being paid by cyclone survivors in order to be let out of the camps. The camp situation was also used to organize voter intimidation for the upcoming national referendum regarding the country's draft constitution on May 24. Survivors were told that a “yes” vote was required in order to receive assistance and aid. By mid June, most camps were shut down as the referendum was completed and citizens were forced to return to their villages.

Medical assistance was also lacking following Nargis. Medical support was delayed and numerous teams had visas cancelled for no apparent reason. This obstruction was especially costly to the children of Myanmar who were in desperate need of medicine and treatment.